Apex Systems — RFP Response

Customer Service Platform Modernisation for Contoso Retail (fictional)

1. Executive Summary & Understanding of Requirement

Apex Systems proposes a cloud-native, microservices-based customer service platform designed for 5x peak load with full API-first integration to the existing ERP, CRM and order management systems.

2. Proposed Solution & Implementation Approach

Event-driven architecture on Kubernetes with an API gateway, 42 pre-built connectors (SAP, Salesforce, ServiceNow), autoscaling, multi-region active-active deployment and 99.95% availability target. Load tested to 20,000 concurrent agents.

3. Timeline, Team Structure & Milestones

Milestone	Timing
Discovery & design	Weeks 1-4
Core build	Weeks 5-14
Integration & testing	Weeks 15-20
Go-live & hypercare	Weeks 21-24

Team of 14: solution architect, 2 security engineers, 8 developers, 2 QA, 1 delivery manager.

4. Pricing

Item	Price
Licences (3 yrs)	$780,000
Implementation	$420,000
Support (3 yrs)	$150,000
Total	$1,350,000

Assumptions: Prices exclude client-side hardware; 10% contingency recommended.

5. Security, Compliance & Risk Controls

ISO 27001 and SOC 2 Type II certified; encryption AES-256 at rest and TLS 1.3 in transit; GDPR DPA provided; quarterly penetration tests; immutable audit logs retained 7 years; role-based access with SSO/MFA.

Risk management: Risk register with 12 tracked risks; integration risk mitigated by connector library.

6. Support Model, Experience & References

24x7 support with 1-hour P1 response; named technical account manager.

11 similar deployments in retail; references: Northwind Stores (fictional), Fabrikam Outlets (fictional).

This is a fictional document created for a classroom exercise.